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(12) **United States Plant Patent**  
**Wood**

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(54) **PHYSOCARPUS PLANT NAMED ‘SMPOTW’**

(50) Latin Name: *Physocarpus opulifolius*  
Varietal Denomination: **SMPOTW**

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patent is extended or adjusted under 35  
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(52) **U.S. Cl.**  
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(58) **Field of Classification Search**  
USPC ..... **Plt./226**  
See application file for complete search history.

(56) **References Cited**

**PUBLICATIONS**

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(57) **ABSTRACT**

A new and distinct cultivar of *Physocarpus* plant named  
‘SMPOTW’, characterized by its compact, upright and uni-  
form plant habit; vigorous growth habit; freely branching  
habit; dense and bushy habit; small dark green-colored leaves  
that become greyed purple in color under high light (full sun)  
conditions and red during the autumn; showy inflorescences  
with numerous pink-colored flower buds and white and pink-  
colored flowers; good garden performance; and resistance to  
Powdery Mildew.

**2 Drawing Sheets**

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Botanical designation: *Physocarpus opulifolius*.  
Cultivar denomination: ‘SMPOTW’.

**BACKGROUND OF THE INVENTION**

The present invention relates to a new and distinct *Physo-*  
*carpus* plant, botanically known as *Physocarpus opulifolius*  
and hereinafter referred to by the name ‘SMPOTW’.

The new *Physocarpus* plant is a product of a controlled  
breeding program conducted by the Inventor in Grand Haven,  
Mich. The objective of the breeding program is to create new  
*Physocarpus* plants with unique flower forms.

The new *Physocarpus* plant originated from an open-pol-  
lination during the summer of 2006 in Grand Haven, Mich. of  
*Physocarpus opulifolius* ‘Seward’, disclosed in U.S. Plant  
Pat. No. 14,821, as the female, or seed, parent with an  
unknown selection of *Physocarpus opulifolius* as the male, or  
pollen, parent. The new *Physocarpus* plant was discovered  
and selected by the Inventor in 2008 as a single flowering  
plant within the progeny of the stated open-pollination in a  
controlled environment in Grand Haven, Mich.

Asexual reproduction of the new *Physocarpus* plant by  
softwood cuttings in a controlled environment in Grand  
Haven, Mich. since July, 2008 has shown that the unique  
features of this new *Physocarpus* plant are stable and repro-  
duced true to type in successive generations of asexual repro-  
duction.

**SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION**

Plants of the new *Physocarpus* have not been observed  
under all possible environmental conditions and cultural

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practices. The phenotype may vary somewhat with variations  
in environmental conditions such as temperature and light  
intensity without, however, any variance in genotype.

The following traits have been repeatedly observed and are  
determined to be the unique characteristics of ‘SMPOTW’.  
These characteristics in combination distinguish ‘SMPOTW’  
as a new and distinct *Physocarpus* plant:

1. Compact, upright and uniform plant habit.
2. Vigorous growth habit.
3. Freely branching habit; dense and bushy habit.
4. Small dark green-colored leaves that become greyed  
purple in color under high light (full sun) conditions and  
red during the autumn.
5. Showy inflorescences with numerous pink-colored  
flower buds and white and pink-colored flowers.
6. Good garden performance.
7. Resistant to Powdery Mildew.

Plants of the new *Physocarpus* can be compared to plants  
of the female parent, ‘Seward’. Plants of the new *Physocar-*  
*pus* differ from plants of ‘Seward’ in the following character-  
istics:

1. Plants of the new *Physocarpus* are more compact than  
plants of ‘Seward’.
2. Plants of the new *Physocarpus* have smaller leaves than  
plants of ‘Seward’.
3. Plants of the new *Physocarpus* and ‘Seward’ differ in  
leaf color as plants of ‘Seward’ have dark purple-colored  
leaves.
4. Flowers of plants of the new *Physocarpus* are darker  
pink in color than flowers of plants of ‘Seward’.



Plants of the new *Physocarpus* can be compared to plants of the *Physocarpus* 'Little Devil', not patented. In side-by-side comparisons conducted in Grand Haven, Mich., plants of the new *Physocarpus* differed from plants of 'Little Devil' in the following characteristics:

1. Plants of the new *Physocarpus* were more compact than plants of 'Little Devil'.
2. Plants of the new *Physocarpus* and 'Little Devil' differed in leaf color.
3. Plants of the new *Physocarpus* were more resistant to Powdery Mildew than plants of 'Little Devil'.

#### BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE PHOTOGRAPHS

The accompanying colored photographs illustrate the overall appearance of the new *Physocarpus*, showing the colors as true as it is reasonably possible to obtain in colored reproductions of this type. Colors in the photographs may differ slightly from the color values cited in the detailed botanical description which accurately describe the colors of the new *Physocarpus*.

The photograph on the first sheet is a side perspective view of a typical flowering plant of 'SMPOTW' grown under full sun conditions in an outdoor nursery in late spring/early summer.

The photograph on the second sheet is a close-up view of a typical plant of 'SMPOTW' grown under full sun conditions in an outdoor nursery in the autumn.

#### DETAILED BOTANICAL DESCRIPTION

The aforementioned photographs and following observations, measurements and values describe plants grown during the late spring, summer and autumn under full sun conditions in ground beds in an outdoor nursery in Grand Haven, Mich. and under cultural practices typical of commercial production. Plants were three years old when the photographs and the description were taken. In the description, color references are made to The Royal Horticultural Society Colour Chart, 1995 Edition, except where general terms of ordinary dictionary significance are used.

Botanical classification: *Physocarpus opulifolius* 'SMPOTW'.

Parentage:

*Female, or seed, parent.*—*Physocarpus opulifolius* 'Seward', disclosed in U.S. Plant Pat. No. 14,821.

*Male, or pollen, parent.*—Unknown selection of *Physocarpus opulifolius*, not patented.

Propagation:

*Type.*—By softwood cuttings.

*Time to initiate roots, summer.*—About 25 days at 24° C.

*Time to produce a rooted young plant, summer.*—About two months at 24° C.

*Root description.*—Fine to thick; white and brown in color.

*Rooting habit.*—Freely branching; dense.

Plant description:

*Plant and growth habit.*—Perennial shrub; compact, upright and uniform plant habit; inverted triangle; vigorous growth habit.

*Branching habit.*—Freely branching habit with about 56 lateral branches developing per plant; pinching enhances lateral branch development.

*Plant height.*—About 60 cm.

*Plant diameter (area of spread).*—About 56 cm.

Lateral branch description:

*Length.*—About 42 cm.

*Diameter.*—About 3 mm.

*Internode length.*—About 1.7 cm.

*Texture.*—Smooth, glabrous.

*Aspect.*—Erect to about 20° from vertical.

*Color.*—Close to 46A.

Leaf description:

*Arrangement.*—Alternate, simple.

*Length.*—About 3 cm.

*Width.*—About 2.5 cm.

*Shape.*—Ovate.

*Apex.*—Acute.

*Base.*—Obtuse.

*Margin.*—Lobed, serrulate.

*Texture, upper and lower surfaces.*—Smooth, glabrous.

*Venation pattern.*—Pinnate.

*Color.*—Developing leaves, upper surface: Close to 131A. Developing leaves, lower surface: Close to 197A. Fully expanded leaves, upper surface: Close to 131A or 139A; venation, close to 145B; under full sun conditions, color becoming closer to 187A; during the autumn, color becoming closer to 180A to 180B and 45A, 45B, 45C and 45D. Fully expanded leaves, lower surface: Close to 148B; venation, close to 145C.

*Petioles.*—Length: About 1 cm. Diameter: About 1 mm.

*Texture, upper and lower surfaces:* Smooth, glabrous.

*Color, upper and lower surfaces:* Close to 160A.

Flower description:

*Flower appearance and arrangement.*—Single rotate flowers arranged in terminal and axillary corymbs; corymbs hemispherical in shape; freely flowering habit with usually about 24 flowers per inflorescence and about 264 flowers developing per lateral branch; flowers face upright to outwardly.

*Flower longevity.*—Flowers last for about three to four weeks on the plant; flowers not persistent.

*Natural flowering season.*—Plants flower from May through June in Michigan.

*Fragrance.*—None detected.

*Inflorescence height.*—About 2 cm.

*Inflorescence diameter.*—About 2 cm.

*Flower diameter.*—About 5 mm.

*Flower length (height).*—About 4 mm.

*Flower buds.*—Length: About 3 mm. Diameter: About 3 mm. Shape: Rounded. Color: Close to 57D.

*Petals.*—Quantity and arrangement: Five petals in a single whorl. Length: About 3 mm. Width: About 3 mm. Shape: Elliptic to obovate. Apex: Obtuse. Margin: Entire. Texture, upper and lower surfaces: Smooth, glabrous. Color: When opening, upper surface: Close to 155D with central stripes, close to 58D. When opening, lower surface: Close to 58D. Fully opened, upper and lower surfaces: Close to 155D with central stripes, close to 58D.

*Sepals.*—Quantity and arrangement: Five in a single whorl. Length: About 3 mm. Width: About 2.5 mm. Shape: Broadly subulate. Apex: Acute. Margin: Entire. Texture, upper and lower surfaces: Smooth, glabrous. Color: When opening, upper and lower surfaces: Close to 144A. Fully opened, upper and lower surfaces: Close to 144A; depending on temperature and light levels, color may be tinged or lightly cast with close to 187A.



*Peduncles*.—Length: About 1.5 cm. Diameter: About 2 mm. Strength: Moderately strong. Texture: Smooth, glabrous. Color: Close to 144A; depending on temperature and light levels, color may be tinged or lightly cast with close to 187A.

*Pedicels*.—Length: About 2 cm. Diameter: About 1 mm. Strength: Moderately strong. Texture: Smooth, glabrous. Color: Close to 144A; depending on temperature and light levels, color may be tinged or lightly cast with close to 187A.

*Reproductive organs*.—Androecium: Quantity per flower: About 30. Anther length: About 0.5 mm. Anther shape: Oblong. Anther color: Close to 58A. Amount of pollen: Scarce. Pollen color: Close to 58A. Gynoecium: Quantity per flower: About three to four. Pistil length: About 0.5 mm. Style length: About 0.5 mm. Style color: Close to 145D. Stigma appearance: Globular. Stigma color: Close to 145D. Ovary color: Close to 145D.

*Fruits*.—Length: About 5 mm to 6 mm. Diameter: About 5 mm to 6 mm. Color: When developing, close to 178A becoming closer to 147A with maturity and eventually drying to close to 200B.

*Seeds*.—Quantity per follicle: If present, about two. Length: About 2 mm. Diameter: About 1 mm. Shape: Oblong. Color: Close to 199A to 199B.

Garden performance: Plants of the new *Physocarpus* have been observed to have good garden performance and to tolerate rain, wind and temperatures ranging from about -25° C. to about 35° C.

Pathogen & pest resistance: Plants of the new *Physocarpus* have been observed to be resistant to Powdery Mildew. Plants of the new *Physocarpus* have not been shown to be resistant to pests and other pathogens common to *Physocarpus* plants.

It is claimed:

1. A new and distinct *Physocarpus* plant named ‘SMPOTW’ as illustrated and described.

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